Selling to education businesses: who to talk to, and what to ask

Desk research (done online, without talking to anyone yet). Malaysia only, education only. Assembled 2026-10-15 from six research write-ups, called "streams", one per business type or topic.

How to read it. About 30 minutes for sections 1–10. Short on time: read sections 1, 8 and 9 first. Sections 3–7 are detail to look up when needed. Section 10 lists what is still unknown, and section 11 lists sources; skim both.

Tags. Every claim carries one:

- **Known**: a source says so, and the source is listed in section 11.
- **Guess**: reasoning, and the text says what it is reasoning from.
- **Unknown**: searched for and not found.
- **Snippet only**: the fact comes from the preview shown in search results, because the page itself couldn't be opened.

Foreign prices are converted to RM using European Central Bank exchange rates (Sept 2026), so every RM conversion is an estimate.

1. One-page summary

What this is. On 15 Oct you floated a pivot (a big change of direction): sell the university research to education businesses instead of to families at RM50. This pack maps those businesses so you know **who to talk to and what to ask**. It cannot tell you whether anyone would pay. Only conversations can, so the pack ends in a ranked contact list (section 8) and an interview script (section 9), not a verdict.

The six findings that matter most

1. **"Who pays them" splits the market in two.** Agents (companies that place students at universities abroad), portals (websites that match students to courses), some pre-university colleges and most "free" software are paid by universities, through commission (a fee the university pays per enrolled student). An honest, any-university list works against their income.

   Paid consultants (advisers that families pay directly for application help), international schools and scholarship bodies are paid by families, schools or sponsors. For them, an honest list matches what their own customer wants [Known for who pays each type; Guess for the effect].

2. **The list is built by busy, often junior people.**
   - Agent and portal counsellors start on RM3,000–4,500 a month. They have enrolment targets (a set number of students they must sign up) and answer students' messages at night [Known, job ads].
   - One international-school counsellor can be responsible for a 300-student sixth form (the last two years of a British-style school, ages 16–18), plus teaching and pastoral work (looking after students' wellbeing) [Known, KTJ job description].

    - Strategists (the senior advisers who plan each student's applications) at the biggest paid consultancy, Crimson Education, report 40–50 students each [Known, but from Glassdoor (a website where employees review their employers), by staff outside Malaysia].

3. **Nobody in the market shows the total cost of the whole degree in ringgit.** Not the agents, the consultants, the universities' own counsellors or the software (Cialfo, BridgeU, Unifrog, ApplyBoard: online platforms that schools and agents use to manage applications). HELP and INTI colleges give rough cost estimates, and Unifrog shows tuition only [Known for every page opened]. This is the clearest gap the product fills.
4. **Prices already paid for similar tools are low.** Software that schools already buy costs about RM19 to RM137 per student, or RM3,300–4,100 a year for a school licence (one yearly fee for the whole school) [Known prices; RM is an estimate]. That is close to your RM50, not far above it. A higher B2B (business-to-business) price would have to come from **doing the work for them** (a service), not from the list itself [Guess].
5. **Handling a client's student data makes you a "data processor" under PDPA (the Personal Data Protection Act), and since 2025 that role has its own legal duties.** A data processor is a company that handles personal data on another company's behalf. The duties are manageable at your size, but the client must accept that student data goes through overseas services (Claude, the AI model, and Firecrawl, a web-scraping service) [Known for the law; Guess for how it applies to you].
6. **The evidence of problems comes from job ads, not from customers.** No Malaysian forum or review evidence was found in any stream. Which problems these businesses would pay to fix (their "pain points") is still unconfirmed.

Recommendation (Guess, to be tested). Talk first to **international-school university counsellors** (school staff who help students apply to universities) and **small paid consultancies**. Both are paid by families, both are short of time, and neither loses money when a list is honest. Use the **Sunway College placement-office chat**, which is already planned, as the first conversation because it costs nothing to set up. Treat agents and private universities as people to *learn from*, not to sell to.

> **Before you pitch any business, decide this:** an agent, a college or a university will probably ask for a version filtered to their partner universities, or with the "reasons not to go" taken out. That would break the product's main promise. Decide in advance whether you would accept it, not during a meeting.

2. B2B primer

B2B means **business-to-business**: you sell to an organisation, not to a family. It works differently from selling RM50 lists, in ways that change what you ask in an interview.

Term	Plain meaning	Why it matters here
Buyer vs user	The person who signs (a principal, a founder, a procurement office: the department that handles purchases) is often not the person who uses the product (a counsellor)	Get the user to want it, then find out who signs. Ask "who approved the last tool you bought?"
Payer vs customer	Who hands over the money may not be the person being served. Agents serve students, but universities pay them	This is the conflict test: whoever pays decides what "a good list" means
Sales cycle	Time from first meeting to payment	One meeting at a small agency or consultancy. Months at a university group or a government body [Guess]
Procurement	An organisation's formal buying process: forms, approved-supplier lists, quotations (formal written price offers)	Large groups and MARA have one. It can block a sole trader (a one-person business) outright (section 6)
Pilot	A small, time-limited trial, ideally paid, before a bigger deal	Your first B2B offer would be a pilot, e.g. 10 students in one cohort (year group)
Commitment	Something the buyer gives up to move forward: time, reputation, money or data	The only real signal in an interview. Compliments aren't commitments (section 9)
Done-for-you service	You do the work and hand over the result	What you can actually deliver today, since the product is you running the pipeline (the step-by-step research process, done per student)
White-label	Your work sold under the client's brand, with your name off it	Consultants may want this. It hides who did the research
Licence / subscription	A yearly fee for access, flat or per student	How schools already buy Cialfo, Unifrog and similar platforms
Per-seat	A price per staff user per month	How agent CRMs (customer-tracking software) are priced
Retainer	A fixed monthly fee for ongoing work, whatever the volume	Steady income for you; the client pays even in quiet months, so it is hard to win early

Term	Plain meaning	Why it matters here
Churn	Customers who stop paying, usually at renewal	Schools renew yearly and do switch vendors (suppliers); Epsom appears to have
Lead / conversion	A lead is an interested student's contact details; conversion is the share who enrol	Universities and agents are measured on this. It shows what they value
Commission	A fee the university pays an agent per enrolled student	The core conflict with an any-university list
Data controller / processor	The controller decides why student data is used; the processor handles it only on the controller's instructions	In every B2B deal you'd be the processor (section 6)

3. Map of the players

Six buyer types. "Ability to pay" is how much spending evidence was found, not a forecast.

Who they are

Buyer type	Examples	Who pays them	Size (sourced)
Agents and free portals	IDP, MABECS, AECC, AUG, Uni Enrol, EduAdvisor, EasyUni	Universities, through commission (UK about 10%, large agents 20%+; Malaysian flat fees RM1,000–2,000)	IDP: 9 Malaysian offices, 40+ counsellors. Uni Enrol 51–100 staff
Paid consultants	Crimson, PrepWorks, Axiom, TigerCampus, Ivy Summit; Inquota (hybrid)	Families: RM2,000 (Inquota) to RM100,000+ (Crimson, Ivy Summit)	Mostly small: PrepWorks 12 staff. No market count exists
Pre-U college placement offices (in-house offices that help students apply onward)	Taylor's UPS, Sunway IOUP, HELP SPC, INTI UPO, MCKL	The college, from tuition. Some may also earn commission (Taylor's is on Liverpool's agent list)	No headcount published
International-school counsellors	Alice Smith, ISKL, KTJ, IGBIS, Epsom, King Henry VIII, Straits Rawang	Parents, through school fees	348 schools, 111,185 students (2024)

Buyer type	Examples	Who pays them	Size (sourced)
Scholarship bodies	MARA, JPA (government sponsors); Bank Negara, Petronas, Yayasan Khazanah, Yayasan Sime Darby	Government or company budgets	JPA RM38,115–277,515 per overseas scholar a year (2016)
Private universities and branch campuses (Malaysian campuses of foreign universities)	Taylor's, Sunway, INTI, UCSI, SEGi, Monash, Nottingham, Heriot-Watt	Families, through tuition. They *pay* agents	384 private institutions (2024), 558,692 students (2023)

How well they fit

Buyer type	Main problem found	Ability to pay	Conflict with an honest list
Agents and free portals	Junior staff on targets, busiest after exam results, facts checked by hand	Medium. They earn per student but pay small sums for tools	**High.** They earn nothing when a student picks a university that doesn't pay them
Paid consultants	Strategists carry 40–50 students each (not Malaysian evidence); no cost data in what they offer	Medium to high per firm, but few firms	**Low** for family-paid firms. Inquota may also earn commission (unconfirmed)
Pre-U college placement offices	Placement targets (job-ad snippets), one advisor per country	Low to medium. Bought through the group's central purchasing	**Mixed.** They own universities competing for the same students
International-school counsellors	One counsellor doing many jobs; asked for "impartial, data-based" advice	Medium. 10+ schools already pay for guidance software	**Low.** But free university-funded tools set the price at zero
Scholarship bodies	Country lists keep changing; cost per scholar is watched closely	High budgets, but no sign they buy placement help	**None on money**, but they fix the university list themselves

Buyer type	Main problem found	Ability to pay	Conflict with an honest list
Private universities and branch campuses	Few enquiries become students (Taylor's: 2.7% of online leads enrol); sales targets	High: proven software buyers (e.g. Salesforce, a sales-tracking system)	**Highest.** They pay to win *this* student

How the money flows [Known for each payment, from streams 1–4]:

- Families pay universities (tuition).
- Universities pay agents, portals and aggregator platforms (websites listing many universities' courses in one place) per student.
- Universities pay software firms such as BridgeU and Studyportals for leads and visibility (being shown to students).
- Families pay consultants and schools directly.
- Sponsors pay universities and negotiate discounts (MARA gets up to 30% off at some Australian universities).

Every payment that comes from a university carries the conflict.

4. One profile per buyer type

4.1 Agents and free portals

What they do. Two kinds. **Study-abroad agents** (IDP, MABECS, AECC, SI-UK, AUG, JM Education and many smaller firms) mainly send students to the UK and Australia from walk-in offices. **Online portals** (Uni Enrol, EduAdvisor, EasyUni) mainly send students to Malaysian private colleges and now do study-abroad too [Known].

Who pays. The institution, in almost every case. MABECS: "Our fees are covered by partner universities". Uni Enrol: "the university pays a service fee". IDP's own financial reports say its placement count "does not include students placed into non-clients for which we do not receive a commission" [Known]. Some agents sell paid extras to families: SI-UK's "Premium Application Service" and AECC's "Premium Counselling", with no prices shown [Known from SI-UK snippet and the AECC page].

Key numbers.

- IDP (the only agent that publishes its financial results) earned A$367.0m (367 million Australian dollars) from 70,076 placements (students it placed at universities) in FY25, its financial year 2025. That is about A$5,237, or roughly **RM15,200, per placed student** [Known; RM estimate]. Malaysia isn't reported separately.
- IDP's placements fell 29% in FY25 and 27% in FY26, and it cut about 1,250 jobs [Known].
- UK commission averaged £1,659–3,529 per student at four universities in 2021/22, with a "standard 10%" and large agents reportedly on 20%+ [Known].
- Malaysian institutions that publish a rate pay a flat **RM1,000–2,000** per student (MEDIU 2016, USIM RM1,500 in two RM750 instalments, UTHM RM2,000) [Known].

- Uni Enrol said in 2020 that it earns 10% of first-year tuition [Known, from a sponsored article, i.e. one the company paid to have published].

How they build a list. IDP counsellors use an "AI-enabled Recommendation Engine" (86% of them use it). Uni Enrol has its own matching over 39,000+ courses. EduAdvisor consultants "research student questions and confirm information with university representatives" by hand [Known]. Whether IDP's engine recommends only partners is Unknown, but likely, since non-partners earn nothing [Guess].

Pain (from job ads). "A high conversion rate into applications and enrollments", "willing to answer priority messages at night from students", overtime "after exam results", fresh graduates welcome [Known, Uni Enrol and EduAdvisor ads, Oct 2026]. Staff are new and learn thousands of courses on the job [Guess, from the little experience the ads ask for].

Fit. Direct conflict. A list that ranks a non-partner (a university that doesn't pay the agent) first takes money from the agent. Possible openings, all Guess:

- A research tool used by junior staff behind the scenes, never shown to families under the agent's brand.
- Students heading somewhere the agent doesn't cover.
- Reach/Match/Safety sorting (hard to get into / realistic / very likely) to cut drop-outs. Some UK universities take back the commission when a student drops out early (the University of East Anglia does, Known).

4.2 Paid consultants

> **Note on Inquota.** Inquota sells packages to families (from RM2,000). Its site also lists "100+" partner universities and ties to ICEF (an organisation that runs events where agents meet universities), and doesn't say whether universities pay it [Known]. Treat it as **unconfirmed: it may also earn commission**. Earlier notes (`competitors.md, status.md`) called it family-paid. Don't use it as the example of a family-paid buyer until it answers "who pays you?".

What they do. Three different businesses [Known]:

- **(a) Crimson Education**, a global premium firm. It sells to Malaysian families from its Singapore team, and no KL office was confirmed.
- **(b) Small boutiques (small specialist firms) for KL international-school students** aiming at top US and UK universities: PrepWorks (KL-founded, 12 staff), Axiom Learning (Mont Kiara), TigerCampus (online tutoring plus counselling), and foreign firms selling into KL (Ivy Summit, InGenius Prep, True North).
- **(c) Hybrid "paid agents" such as Inquota**, which charge a fee and also list partner universities.

Who pays. The family, directly. No type (a) or (b) firm mentions university commission [Known that none mentions it; whether none takes any is Unknown].

Key numbers [Known prices; RM is an estimate]:

- Inquota: from RM2,000 for "full application support".
- TigerCampus: RM70–280 an hour.

- Crimson: S$10,000–30,000 (Singapore dollars) a year in Singapore, about RM31,900–95,700. No Malaysian price is published, so this is the nearest stand-in; don't quote it as Crimson Malaysia's price.
- Ivy Summit, which names Alice Smith, ISKL and Garden International as schools it serves: US$9,500 for a 10-school package (up to 35 hours) up to US$50,000 for its top "VIP" package, about RM38,400–202,000.
- The top end of the market is small: Cambridge got 263 applications from Malaysia in 2024 and admitted 22.

How they build a list. One senior person does it. Crimson's "Strategy Consultant" builds "lists of best fit schools of varied competition", which is Reach/Match/Safety in other words [Known, job ad]. The list is one task inside a multi-year package that is mostly essays, activities and test prep. Prices go up with the number of schools (Ivy Summit, Inquota, Crimson) [Known]. No firm says how long a list takes [Unknown].

Pain. None of this evidence is Malaysian:

- Former Crimson strategists: "40+ student cases per strategist. Feels like an assembly line", pay of US$60–70k "even when they come with YEARS of experience", "rude parents" [Known, Glassdoor].
- No consultant page shows the total degree cost in any currency [Known for the pages opened].
- Customer reviews of Crimson are mostly positive [Known, Trustpilot, a customer-review website]. The problems are with staff workload and price, not obviously with clients.

Fit. The best money fit of any business type: the family pays, so an honest list serves the firm's own customer [Guess]. A strategist with 40–50 students has no time to verify fees, work out the ringgit total or check MQA recognition (whether Malaysia's qualifications agency accepts the degree), and that is exactly what you do [Guess]. The risks:

- The list helps justify a RM30,000+ package, so they may only buy it white-labelled (sold under their own brand, with your name off it).
- Elite US/UK firms may see a Malaysia-plus-anywhere cost list as off-target.
- Lower-priced firms (Inquota, TigerCampus) may value bought-in research more, because they can't afford research hours at their prices [Guess].

4.3 Pre-university college placement offices

What they do. Colleges run in-house offices that help their own A-Level, foundation and diploma students apply onward [Known]:

- Taylor's University Placement Services: "each student is assigned to one of the UPS advisors".
- Sunway's International Office University Placement gives "advice on which universities fit best".
- HELP's Student Placement Centre covers "estimated costs of tuition and living" across 44+ partners.
- INTI's University Placement Office keeps a library of "tuition fees, cost of living" and 150+ credit-transfer tables (lists of which completed subjects count towards a degree elsewhere).
- MCKL has a smaller placement unit.

Who pays. The college, from tuition. A second income stream is possible [Guess, from the agent-list entries below]:

- "Taylor's Malaysia Sdn Bhd" (the company's registered name) is on the University of Liverpool's approved-agent list [Known].
- INTI appears on QUT's (Queensland University of Technology's) "other agents" list [Known, snippet only].
- HELP waives application fees for applications made through its centre [Known].

Pain. Taylor's advisor job ads (expired, snippets only) speak of "KPIs (key performance indicators: the targets staff are measured on) related to placing all students to the universities of their choice". Each advisor acts as a "country custodian", responsible for one country. That suggests nobody's job is to compare countries on cost side by side [Guess]. No college publishes how many advisors it has [Unknown].

Fit. Mixed:

- **In favour:** placement results are their marketing, and HELP and INTI already hand out cost estimates [Known].
- **Against:** Taylor's, Sunway, HELP and INTI each own a university that competes for the same students. Taylor's pays bursaries (discounts) of up to RM8,000 to its own pre-U students who stay on for a Taylor's degree [Known].
- **Lowest-conflict corner: transfer and American-degree programmes** (start a degree in Malaysia, finish it abroad), where the student is leaving anyway. Sunway's School of American Education runs a placement office with workshops on "selecting suitable universities", though Arizona State is its "exclusive partner" [Known].

4.4 International-school university counsellors

What they do. 348 international schools teach 111,185 students in Malaysia, about 67% of them Malaysian [Known; ISC Research figures for July 2024, reported by Asia News Network]. Larger schools have a university counsellor or a small team. ISKL pictures seven people, including an educational psychologist, and reported 550+ offers for its Class of 2026, 37% of them in the US [Known].

Who pays. Parents, through fees. The counsellor is paid by the school, not by universities [Known for fee-funded schools; Guess that no university money reaches them].

Software already in use [Known]:

Platform	Malaysian schools using it
Cialfo	Alice Smith, ISKL, IGBIS
BridgeU	King Henry VIII College
Unifrog	Epsom, UCSI International, Straits Rawang, Kinabalu International (2020 evidence)
MaiaLearning	Oasis International

Platform	Malaysian schools using it
Uni Enrol's Pathway Match	Cempaka

Alice Smith probably uses both Unifrog (named on its careers page) and Cialfo (named in a 2023 blog post) [Known for each page].

Pain. One person, many jobs [Known]:

- KTJ's single "designated US counsellor" for a 300-student sixth form must also tutor, teach personal and social education, write references (recommendation letters), run university fairs and "keep thorough and accurate records of student applications, outcomes and final destinations".
- IGBIS combines wellbeing counselling and college counselling in one role, asking for "impartial, data-based options' counsel".
- Pay at the lower end is RM2,900–4,000 a month.
- Alice Smith's counsellor writes that AI "can only suggest", so counsellors still check the tool's list by hand.

Fit. The best fit on paper [Guess from Known facts]:

- No money conflict.
- "Impartial" advice is written into the job.
- These schools already have a budget line (money set aside each year) for guidance software.

The catches:

- Free tools paid for by universities (BridgeU, Uni Enrol) set the price expectation at zero.
- A per-student service may need a different budget and approver from a software licence.
- A whole cohort is far more than you can do by hand (section 7).

4.5 Scholarship bodies

What they do. They pay for the degree and decide which universities a scholar may attend [Known]:

- Yayasan Khazanah (the foundation of Khazanah Nasional, the government's investment fund): universities "not on the list will not be considered".
- Bank Negara (Malaysia's central bank): approved pre-U colleges, then approved universities.
- JPA (Public Service Department, the main government scholarship body), top programme: "a choice of 20 universities from the QS World University Rankings".
- Yayasan Sime Darby (a company foundation): 10 named Malaysian universities.
- MARA (Majlis Amanah Rakyat, a government agency that sponsors Bumiputera students) "will guide students in choosing universities".

Key numbers [Known]:

- JPA spent RM38,115–277,515 per overseas scholar per year (2016 parliamentary reply, an official answer given in Parliament).

- MARA saves "between RM200,000 and RM300,000 in sponsorship costs per student" through Australian discounts of up to 30%.
- Yayasan Khazanah made 115 awards in 2024.
- MARA moved about 200 US-bound scholars to other countries in 2025 at short notice.

Fit. Strong on cost, weak on "any university".

- Total degree cost in MYR, and Reach/Match/Safety *within their approved list*, match how they already manage budgets [Guess].
- No sponsor was found paying anyone to shortlist today. The only example is a 2015 MARA cohort placed by IIE (Institute of International Education, a US non-profit) [snippet only].
- MARA buys through quotations limited to Bumiputera suppliers registered with the Ministry of Finance (section 6).

This is a later conversation, not a first one.

4.6 Private universities and branch campuses

What they do. Recruit students, and their job ads read like sales jobs [Known]:

- INTI: "Engage & influence prospects (potential students) using selling skills", with an "attractive sales incentive".
- UNITAR's counsellor role is titled "(Global Sales)".
- Heriot-Watt runs scholarships "to drive urgency and improve conversion rates".

What winning a student costs them [Known unless tagged]:

- Agent commission (RM1,000–2,000 flat where published).
- Marketing: SEGi spent RM9.33m in 2025, about 4.5% of revenue (total income).
- Bursaries used as discounts. Taylor's brochure says "The bursary is a form of discount".
- SEGi's accounts show **RM20.1m** of agent commission not yet counted as a cost at the end of 2025, up from RM13.1m. SEGi spreads this cost over each student's years of study, so the figure is a running balance, *not* one year's spending. Don't quote it as "RM20m a year on agents".
- Taylor's converted 2.7% of online leads into enrolments [Known, but reported by SleekFlow, the software company selling the fix].

Fit. The most conflicted buyer. Their counsellors are measured on enrolling students into *their own* programmes, and they pay to keep their own pre-U students (Taylor's up to RM8,000) [Known]. The weaker-conflict corners, all Guess:

- Transfer programmes (see 4.3).
- Branch campuses, whose own sales pitch is total cost against the home campus.
- Research on rival universities for their own staff, which UCSI and UNITAR staff do by hand. That would be a different product, never shown to families.

5. B2B competitors: software already sold to these businesses

These are the real competitors in a B2B pitch: a counsellor will ask "how is this different from what we already have?"

Tool (who uses it)	Who pays for it	Price found (RM estimate)	What it lacks
Cialfo (schools: Alice Smith, ISKL, IGBIS)	Schools. Probably also earns from universities: "preferred partner" to 1,000+	Quote only (price on request). Capterra, a software-review site, shows "Basic SGD48 a month" (about RM150), scope unclear	MYR total cost. Its AI "Uni-Fit" score competes to draft the first list
BridgeU (King Henry VIII College)	**Universities**, from £1,000 a year (about RM5,470). Free to schools	Free to schools	Cost. Its extra matching leaves out Malaysia as a destination
Unifrog (Epsom, UCSI International, Straits Rawang)	Schools. University income Unknown	Primary-school product £600 a year (about RM3,280). Secondary: quote only	Whole-degree cost (shows tuition only)
MaiaLearning (Oasis International)	Schools [Guess]. University income Unknown	Unknown	Not checked in depth
Scoir (no Malaysian user found)	Schools. University income Unknown	US$2.40–4.80 per student a year plus US$250 setup (about RM10–19 per student)	Used here only as a price comparison
ApplyBoard, Adventus (agents; ApplyBoard is one of Edinburgh's seven Malaysian agents)	**Universities**, via commission. Adventus passes agents 100% of commission on "Premium" programmes, 80% elsewhere	Free to agents	Shows partner universities only
Agentcis, Meritto (agents' customer-tracking software)	Agents. No university income	Agentcis US$7 per user a month (about RM28)	No shortlisting at all

Tool (who uses it)	Who pays for it	Price found (RM estimate)	What it lacks
Uni Enrol Pathway Match (Cempaka International)	Unknown for the tool; Uni Enrol itself is paid by partner institutions	Unknown	The closest local competitor: AI matching with "financial considerations"

Three things to know [Known unless tagged]:

- **One owner, both sides.** Manifest Global (Singapore) owns Cialfo *and* BridgeU, plus two study-abroad agencies (Kaaiser, and EduGo Abroad since August 2026). The company selling schools their counselling software also owns agencies whose partners are universities.
- **"Free" guidance funded by universities has gone wrong before.** In the US, Naviance (a school guidance platform) carried paid university adverts next to its match suggestions ("a pay to play kind of idea", a former account executive, i.e. salesperson, told the news site The Markup). Its owner settled a class action (a lawsuit on behalf of a large group of people) over advertising and tracking for US$17.25m [settlement figure: snippet only]. This answers "why not just use a free tool?".
- **The gap is research, not workflow (managing the application steps).** These platforms manage documents, deadlines and submission. None of them shows MYR total cost, separates "good university" from "can you get in" as two columns, or gives honest "don't go" notes [Known for every page opened]. Your list could be attached to a student's file in Cialfo or Unifrog rather than replacing the platform [Guess].

6. How buying works, and the rules

6.1 Who decides

Buyer type	Who decides	How it happens
Small agents, consultancies	Owner or founder	One meeting can be enough [Guess]
IDP and large agents	Regional or head office	Slow and central [Guess]
International schools	Counsellor proposes; head and bursar (the school's finance manager) approve	A yearly subscription, set when the budget is set [Guess, from how Cialfo and Unifrog are sold]
Pre-U colleges, private universities	Head of placement or recruitment proposes; group procurement buys	Sunway Group uses "e-Procurement systems" (online purchasing systems). Education services aren't a listed category, so this would probably be bought as "IT" [Known for the page; Guess for the category]

Buyer type	Who decides	How it happens
MARA, JPA	Procurement unit	MARA quotations are "KHAS UNTUK BUMIPUTERA" (Bumiputera only) and open to suppliers registered with the Ministry of Finance [Known, but from a printing contract; may not apply to services]

6.2 Where they meet

- **Star Education Fair**: about 70 institutions and 100 booths at KLCC in 2025 [Known]. Exhibitors are colleges and universities, so it's good for watching recruitment teams at work.
- **British Council UK Agent and Counsellor Training Hub**: free online training, plus a **public database of certified Malaysian agents and counsellors**, a ready-made contact list [Known].
- **AIMS** (Association of International Malaysian Schools): 40+ member schools (2019), with a yearly teachers' conference [Known].
- **MAPCU and NAPEI** (the two private-college associations): one conversation reaches many institutions [member counts from snippets only].
- **ICEF workshops**, where agents meet universities: the 2026 Asia workshop was in Ho Chi Minh City, not Malaysia [snippet only].

6.3 PDPA: what changes when you handle a client's student data

In a B2B deal the school or firm is the **data controller** (decides why student data is used) and you are its **data processor** (handle the data on its instructions). The 2024 amendment to the law (Act A1727) and the 2025 guidelines from the PDP Commissioner (the regulator) put duties on processors directly [Known; the Act and both guidelines were read in full]:

Duty	What it means for you
Keep the data secure (in force 1 Apr 2025)	Take "practical steps" to protect it. Penalty up to RM1,000,000 or 3 years in prison
Report breaches (leaks or unauthorised access) to the client "promptly" (1 Jun 2025)	Their 72-hour clock to tell the regulator starts when you tell them, so expect this written into your contract
Data Protection Officer (1 Jun 2025)	A named person responsible for data protection. Only needed above 20,000 people, or 10,000 for sensitive or financial data. You are far below this [Guess]

Duty	What it means for you
Data leaving Malaysia (1 Apr 2025)	The client must be satisfied that data sent abroad is protected. Your pipeline sends student profiles through overseas services (Claude, Firecrawl), so each client has to accept that [Guess on application]
Don't reuse their data (since 2013)	A processor handles data "solely on behalf of" the controller. Reusing a client's student data for your own product would make you a controller, with the full set of duties. University research itself isn't personal data, so reusing *that* is fine [Known definition; Guess on application]
Under-18s (since 2013)	For anyone under 18, consent runs through the parent or guardian [Known]

Colleges, universities and private schools are already registered data controllers, so expect them to send you a data processing agreement (a contract setting out these duties) [Guess]. Keep any family-budget field optional or in broad ranges rather than exact figures, since it may count as financial information [Guess].

6.4 Agent codes of conduct: a softer way in

- **UK National Code (2021 edition)**, the UK's code of conduct for agents. Agents must give advice tailored to the student's "capacity to pay", and be open about which universities they represent and which they don't. A July 2025 edition exists but couldn't be opened [Known for 2021].
- **Australia.** Universities must ensure their agents act "in the best interests of the student". Since January 2026 commission on onshore transfers (students switching between Australian providers) is banned [Known].
- **Malaysia.** No licence or code was found for agents sending students abroad. That means "not found", not "confirmed absent" [Unknown].

Why it matters [Guess]: with an agent, the list could be pitched as **compliance evidence** (proof the agent followed these codes): "a dated record that you tailored advice to this family's budget". Pitching it as "honest advice" would imply the agent is dishonest; this framing avoids that.

7. What Evan could sell: offer options

Today the product is you running the research process per student: under 1 hour of hands-on time per student and about RM158 a month in software costs. So the realistic first offer is a service.

Option	What it is	Best fit	Comparable prices found	Main risk
Done-for-you pilot, per student	You build lists for a small group the client picks; they pay per student	International-school counsellors, small consultancies	Morrisby (a UK careers-profiling test) charges £25 (about RM137) per student profile. Your family price is RM50	Your own time. You can't grow past a small group by hand

Option	What it is	Best fit	Comparable prices found	Main risk
White-label	The same list under the client's brand	Paid consultants	**None published** in Malaysia [Unknown]	Your name disappears, and you build no reputation with families
Yearly school licence	A flat fee for a set number of students	Schools that already pay for platforms	Unifrog primary £600 a year (about RM3,280). Morrisby £750 including 30 profiles (about RM4,100)	You need software or a lot of capacity to back a whole-cohort licence
Monthly retainer	A fixed fee for a stream of students	A consultancy with steady volume	**None found** [Unknown]	Hard to win before you have a track record
Software	Counsellors run the tool themselves	Later, if ever	Scoir about RM10–19 per student a year	Can't be built before the 24 Oct pitch (no new software work until then), and it competes head-on with Cialfo and Unifrog

What the prices say [Guess, from Known prices]:

- Per-student software sells at RM10–137 per student. That doesn't support "businesses would pay much more than RM50" for the list alone.
- What a business might pay more for is **the hours you save its staff**: verified fees, the MYR total and recognition checks done for them. Price that as a service.
- Consultancies charge families RM2,000 to RM100,000+, so a research input of a few hundred ringgit per student is small next to their fee. Whether they'd pay it is the interview question.

Capacity [Guess]:

- At under 1 hour of hands-on time per student, a pilot of **about 10 students** is realistic around exams.
- A school's whole cohort is not. KTJ's sixth form alone is 300 students, which would be roughly 300 hours.
- Offer a pilot sized to one counsellor's group, not a school-wide deal.

Red line (a condition you won't accept), again: expect requests for partner-only lists or no "reasons not to go". Decide in advance (section 1).

8. Ranked buyer types to approach first

The ranking is by fit and by how easy each type is to reach, for **conversations**. It isn't a forecast of who will buy.

Rank	Buyer type	Why here	What would move it down
1	**International-school university counsellors** (mid-sized schools first)	No money conflict; "impartial" advice is in their job descriptions; existing software budget; overloaded single counsellors (KTJ, IGBIS) [Known facts; Guess on fit]	If counsellors say Cialfo or Unifrog already covers it, or that per-student services have no budget line
2	**Small paid consultancies** (family-paid boutiques)	The family pays them; a founder decides in one meeting; list-building is research-heavy and squeezed (strategist caseloads) [Guess, partly from non-Malaysian evidence]	If list-building turns out to take them little time, or they serve only students aiming at Ivy League (top US) universities or Oxford/ Cambridge
3	**Pre-U college placement offices**, especially transfer and American-degree programmes	You can reach Sunway already. Placement results are their marketing. Transfer students leave anyway	If commission or own-university progression decides their advice
4	**Scholarship foundations** (Khazanah, Sime Darby, Bank Negara)	Cost-per-scholar thinking matches your MYR total	Approved lists, procurement rules (MARA buys only from Bumiputera suppliers registered with the Ministry of Finance); no evidence they buy placement help
5	**Agents and portals**	Talk to learn how lists are built and what tools cost, not to sell	Direct conflict: they earn nothing when a student picks a university that doesn't pay them
6	**Private universities' recruitment teams**	Only for market knowledge (commission rates, cost per enrolment)	They pay to win the student your list might send elsewhere

Your first five calls [Guess; contact routes are public pages]:

1. **Sunway College placement office (IOUP) or a Sunway counsellor.** Already planned, and it is your own college, so access is free. Ask the section 9 pre-U questions, including "which universities pay the college?".
2. **One international-school counsellor. Alice Smith** (its Higher Education and Careers counsellor has written publicly about Cialfo's limits) or **KTJ** (a 300-student sixth form, recently hiring a counsellor). Route: the school's contact page or LinkedIn company page.
3. **PrepWorks** (KL-founded, 12 staff, UK, US and medicine). Small enough to reach the founder. Route: its contact form or LinkedIn company page.
4. **Inquota.** It's the only firm with a published RM price, and the one call that settles whether it is family-paid or also takes commission. Route: inquota.com.my consult form.
5. **Sunway School of American Education transfer office.** This is the lowest-conflict use inside an institution: it already builds overseas lists for students who are leaving anyway.

Next in line: Epsom College (appears to have switched from BridgeU to Unifrog; ask why), Straits International School Rawang (a mid-market school that tests price), and AIMS (one route to 40+ schools).

Timing [Guess]:

- Before the 24 Oct LaunchX pitch: one of these calls (the Sunway chat), as the mentor suggested, plus one of the three questions for the investor panel.
- After exams: the rest, aiming to have a pilot offer ready for the LaunchX pilot week, 10–13 Nov.

9. Interview script (Mom Test style)

The rule from *The Mom Test* (a book about customer interviews): ask about what people **did** and **spent** in the past, never "would you buy this?". People are polite about the future and truthful about the past.

Opening (30 seconds). "I'm a student building a university-shortlist service. I'm not selling anything today. I'm trying to understand how [schools / consultancies / colleges] build a student's university list now. Can I ask about the last few you did?"

Core questions, for everyone

1. Walk me through the last student whose university list you built. Who built it, how long did it take, and what did you open?
2. Where did the fee and entry-requirement figures come from? Who checked them, and when?
3. The last time a family asked what the whole degree would cost in ringgit, what did you give them, and how long did it take?
4. How many students does each person carry at the busiest point? What gets squeezed?
5. In the last year, did a list go wrong (wrong fee, missed requirement, course not recognised at home)? What did it cost you?
6. What did you spend last year on tools, data or outside help for this? Who signed it off, and when is it up for renewal?

7. The last time you started paying a new outside service, who suggested it, who signed, and how long from first meeting to payment?

Add-ons by type (pick two or three)

- *International-school counsellors:* Which platform do you use (Unifrog, Cialfo, BridgeU, a spreadsheet), and what does the school pay for it? Which platform suggestions made the final list, and which did you add by hand? Have agents or portals offered you free tools, and what did you say?
- *Paid consultants:* How do you price: per school, per package or per hour? Which part do families argue about? Do any universities you recommend pay you anything? (Ask Inquota this first.) What share of students go somewhere other than the US or UK, and who builds those lists?
- *Pre-U placement offices:* Which universities pay the college when a student enrols, and roughly what share of last year's placements went to them? Have you recommended a university with no agreement with you, and what happened?
- *Scholarship bodies:* How was this year's approved list built? When the US-bound scholars were moved in 2025, who did the re-placing and how long did it take? Have you ever paid an outside organisation to place scholars?
- *Agents and portals:* When a student asked about a university you don't partner with, what happened? How do new consultants learn the courses, and how long until they work alone? Has a partner university ever checked your advice against the UK or Australian code, and what did it ask to see?
- *Data (anyone you might pilot with):* Since the 2025 PDPA changes, has a vendor had to sign a data processing agreement with you? What did you insist on?

Show the sample last, and only one made-up student. After the past-behaviour questions, show a sample list for a made-up student (never a real one). Ask what they would change, then: "If a list like this put another university above one you'd normally recommend, what would happen?" Watch their reaction; it answers the conflict question better than any direct question.

What counts as a commitment (from weakest to strongest):

Signal	Counts?
"Interesting", "send me some info", "we'd definitely use this"	**No.** These are compliments
A second meeting with a date in it	A little: they give time

Signal	Counts?
An introduction to the person who signs, or to a peer at another school or firm	Yes: they risk their reputation
Real student details with names removed, for a trial, under a data agreement	Yes: they give data and effort
A paid pilot with a named price, a student count and a start date	**Yes. This is the test**

After each call, write down within the hour:

- what they did last time
- what they spent
- who signs
- the strongest commitment offered
- any surprise

These notes are the evidence this desk research cannot provide.

10. Open unknowns, by stream

Things the research looked for and couldn't confirm, grouped by stream. This section is for reference. **The five that matter most** are marked ★; read those and skim the rest.

Across all streams

- ★ **No Malaysian forum, review or customer evidence of pain** in any stream. Every pain point comes from job ads, software companies' own case studies or non-Malaysian reviews. *How to find out:* interviews only.
- ★ **Nobody publishes how long a shortlist takes**, at any business type. *How to find out:* core question 1 (section 9).

Stream 1: agents and portals

- No public register or count of education agents in Malaysia, and no market share for any agent.
- No published split of commission between a master agent and a sub-agent (a smaller agent working through a bigger one).
- Counsellor caseloads aren't stated in any ad.

- Whether IDP's recommendation engine suggests only partner universities.
- No agent or portal publishes a whole-degree cost in ringgit (looked at IDP, MABECS, AECC, Uni Enrol, EduAdvisor).
- IDP doesn't report Malaysia separately; SI-UK's paid service has no Malaysian price.

Stream 2: paid consultants

- ★ **Inquota: who pays it.** It may also earn commission. *How to find out:* ask Inquota directly.
- Crimson's Malaysian price is borrowed from Singapore, and no KL office was confirmed.
- Most boutiques publish no prices (PrepWorks, Axiom, InGenius, True North).
- No count of paid consultants in Malaysia or of what families spend on them.
- Pain points are from Crimson staff worldwide and a 2019 New Zealand article, not Malaysia.

Stream 3: colleges, schools, scholarship bodies

- No pre-U college publishes advisor headcount or caseload.
- Whether colleges earn commission rests on two findings; INTI's is a snippet only.
- Taylor's placement-KPI wording is from expired ads seen as snippets.
- Scholarship spend figures are old (JPA 2016, Khazanah 2013), so treat them as a minimum.
- No international-school counselling budget found.
- KDU/UOW, Nilai and Monash foundation placement offices weren't found.

Stream 4: private universities

- ★ **No large private group or branch campus publishes its agent commission.** The RM1,000–2,000 range is from MEDIU (2016) and two public universities.
- No cost per enrolment or recruitment-team size published. "37 online leads per enrolment" is arithmetic from Taylor's 2.7%, which itself comes from a vendor.
- The 527,000 Malaysians at private institutions is a subtraction from Ministry of Higher Education (MOHE) totals, not an official figure.
- HELP, Curtin, Xiamen and Southampton Malaysia were only lightly researched.

Stream 5: software

- ★ **Secondary-school prices for Cialfo, Unifrog and MaiaLearning are hidden** (price given only on request). *How to find out:* counsellor question "what does the school pay?".
- Unconfirmed whether Cialfo or Unifrog also earn money from universities.
- No Malaysian user complaints found; review counts are tiny.
- Sri KDU Klang's Unifrog use is a snippet; Kinabalu's evidence is from 2020.
- Epsom "switching" from BridgeU to Unifrog is an inference from two dated pages.

Stream 6: selling and rules

- No Malaysian licence or code found for agents sending students abroad ("not found", not "absent").

- No published white-label or retainer price; Edvisor's US$150 a month is a snippet from a page that no longer loads.
- UK agent-code quotes are from the 2021 edition.
- MARA's Bumiputera/MOF rule is from a printing contract and may not apply to services.
- Event details from snippets only: UK Education Insights Forum 2026 dates, Star Education Fair 2026, the counsellors' conference, MAPCU/NAPEI member counts, the ICEF exam fee.
- PDP Commissioner's Circular No. 1/2026 (registration) is a scanned PDF and wasn't read.

11. All sources

Each stream's sources table, copied unchanged from its fragment. "Did I open the page?" is the research agent's own record.

Spot-checks (pages re-opened by hand to confirm figures; all matched):

- Stream 4: Taylor's 2.7% conversion and SleekFlow figures; Taylor's bursary wording and the up to RM8,000 progression bursary.
- Stream 5: Scoir's per-student price and setup fee; Adventus's 100%/80% split; Manifest Global buying EduGo Abroad; Alice Smith naming Cialfo.
- Stream 2: Inquota's RM2,000 and its "200+"/"2000+" contradiction; Ivy Summit's package prices; Alice Smith's careers page naming Unifrog.
- Commission rates (15 Oct): USIM RM1,500 in two RM750 instalments, the second withheld if the student doesn't re-register; PIE News 2021/22 per-student averages (Exeter £3,529, Kingston £3,055, Durham £2,819, Kent £1,659) and the "standard 10%".

Stream 1: agents and free portals

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
IDP FY25: placement revenue A$367.0m, 70,076 placements, A$5,237 average price, Asia A$569.8m, source-country split, non-client footnote, Recommendation Engine with 86% adoption	IDP FY25 results presentation (ASX, 28 Aug 2025)	Yes (PDF downloaded and text extracted)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
IDP FY25 headline: revenue A$882.2m, volumes down 29%, price up 15%	IDP FY25 ASX announcement	Yes (PDF extracted)
IDP FY26: A$795m, volumes down 27%, yield up 11%, ~1,250 roles cut, Malaysia as a new destination	IDP FY26 results presentation (ASX, 20 Aug 2026)	Yes (PDF extracted; the table layout was garbled, so I used only the clearly labelled figures)
IDP Malaysia: 9 offices, 40+ counsellors, 30+ years	idp.com/malaysia/why-choose-idp-malaysia	Yes
IDP: 210+ offices, 113K students helped in 2024, free counselling, cost calculator	idp.com/malaysia	Yes
MABECS: fees covered by partners, 3 offices, 90–100+ partners, 1,000+ students	mabecs.com	Yes
AECC: free core services, 3 Malaysian offices, 1,100+ partners, Premium Counselling	aeccglobal.com/my counselling page	Yes
SI-UK: KL office, free basic help, paid Premium Application Service	gostudyin.com	No, search snippet only

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
AUG: founded 1995, branch counts	edufair.fsi.com.my/aug, Hiredly	No, search snippet only
Agent names and locations in Malaysia	Plymouth agents in Malaysia, Sheffield reps	Yes
Uni Enrol: the university pays a service fee, 250+ partners, RM83m in scholarships	unienrol.com	Yes
Uni Enrol earns 10% of first-year tuition; RM300 bursary (sponsored, 2020)	Vulcan Post	Yes
Uni Enrol is paid by institutions on enrolment; 76 universities (2020)	The Edge Malaysia	Yes
Uni Enrol business model "marketplace commission"; funding history	Caplight	No, search snippet only
Uni Enrol and GEA strategic investment, June 2025	Bernama	No, search snippet only
Uni Enrol job ads (Junior RM3,000–4,500; Senior RM5,000–6,000; targets, night messages); 51–100 staff	JobStreet 95085556, JobStreet 95085869	Yes (via Firecrawl, because WebFetch was blocked with a 403 error; saved in `.tmp/b2b_research/01_3_jobs.json`)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Uni Enrol older ad: RM3,000–4,000, commission on target, weekends in peak	SEGi partners post	Yes
EduAdvisor job ad: RM3,000–4,500, research and check facts, case targets; 11–50 staff	JobStreet 95061775	Yes (via Firecrawl)
Education consultant average salary ~RM3,750–3,800 by locality	JobStreet salary insights	Yes (via Firecrawl)
EduAdvisor: small fee per application, referral fees, advertisers, 100+ partners	eduadvisor.my/help-centre	Yes
EduAdvisor: founded 2014, 5M students served	eduadvisor.my/about-us	Yes
EasyUni: money from services to universities, 100+ institutions, 11M+ users	easyuni.com/about	Yes
EasyUni sells listings, verified leads, events; 2013 mention of commission	yespress profile, Digital News Asia	No, search snippet only

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
UK 2011/12: £120m, ~£1,000 per student, ~10%, Nottingham £1,450 flat	PIE News 2013	Yes
UK 2021/22 per-student averages; "standard 10%", 20%+ for large agents	PIE News 2022	Yes
UK 2013-14: £1,767 per student, £86.7m	THE	No, search snippet only
10–30% of first-year fees, £500m, 50% of admissions via agents	Exeposé, citing Big Issue	Yes (Big Issue original not opened)
UEA contract clauses: clawback, splits, 2nd-year cut-off	UEA FOI 25-270	Yes
Edinburgh: partial commission from Sept 2026, sub-agent consent, no pay if not in student's interest	Edinburgh agent guidance	Yes
AQF pledge asks agents to list sub-agents	PIE / BUILA article	No, search snippet only
Australia: commissions up to 2× other destinations; A$17,500 of A$30,000 kept; 13% recruited directly	THE on Nous Group, 18 Dec 2024	Yes

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Australia 2015: 11–17% of tuition	Productivity Commission via Go8	No, search snippet only
School schedule 25%/15%/10%	Hutchins School 2024 PDF	No, search snippet only
MEDIU flat RM300 per short-course student	MEDIU agent agreement	No, search snippet only
BUILA/UKCISA: 31% of staff, 24% of students see bias	THE, 30 Mar 2021	Yes
Malaysian Monash graduate's account of being steered	Study International, 2 Oct 2024	Yes
"Agent who doesn't charge… may prefer this institution"	Australian High Commission Singapore	Yes

Stream 2: paid consultants

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Inquota: RM2,000+ packages, free first consult, 100+ partners, ICEF/agency partnerships, 200+ vs 2000+ placements, shortlist inputs, 6–8 month timeline	inquota.com.my	Yes (WebFetch and Firecrawl scrape)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Crimson Malaysia page: team roles, strategist builds the school list, 1,330+ Ivy and 380+ Oxbridge offers, admit-rate table	Crimson Malaysia campaign page	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)
Crimson Asia page: 1,733 Ivy and 457 Oxbridge offers; consultant "curates the perfect school list"	crimsoneducation.org/ap	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)
Crimson app-year-my page names GIS, ISKL, Alice Smith	app-year-my	No. Search snippet only (HTTP 429 on open)
Crimson: 21 markets, USD 40M Series D at USD 640M, Crimson Rise ages 10–14	Crimson Rise job ad	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)
"Lists of best fit schools of varied competition"; "high number of students"; hourly part-time contract; Crimson App	Asia Strategy Consulting job ad	Yes
No Malaysia roles on Crimson's open-jobs list (Singapore and "Remote - SE Asia" roles shown)	jobs.crimsoneducation.org/jobs	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Crimson offices (no KL), staff 2022, 8,000 clients 2024, FY2024 revenue, "upwards of USD 25,000", controversies	Wikipedia: Crimson Education	Yes
Crimson JobStreet profile: HK address, 11–50, no MY listings	JobStreet company page	Yes
S$10k–30k/year, ~40 SG staff, regional manager covers Malaysia, stigma	Vulcan Post (sponsored)	Yes
Crimson Facebook covers SG, MY, PH, Myanmar	facebook.com/crimson.singapore	No. Search snippet only
Caseload 40–50, pay $60–70k, rude parents, burnout, 3.5/5 from 36 reviews	Glassdoor Strategy Consultant and Senior Strategy Consultant reviews	Yes (Firecrawl scrape; WebFetch was 403)
Sales playbook, NZ$15k/30k targeting, contract lock-in, 6–9 contacts/ month	The Spinoff, 14 Nov 2019	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)
Trustpilot: 138 reviews mostly positive; "country/global strategist"; fee-surprise quote	Trustpilot Crimson	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Consultants leave cost and scholarships unaddressed; Crimson USD 25k–200k	Orbit review (competitor)	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)
Crimson essay bundles USD 425/800/1,500	Lumiere Education review	No. Search snippet only
Crimson US/UK admissions calculators	Crimson 360 e-book / site menu	No. Search summary only
PrepWorks services, TTDI address, no prices	prep.works UK & US admissions	Yes
PrepWorks founded 2015, 11–50 (12) employees	LinkedIn prepworks-my	Yes
Axiom Mont Kiara services; "majority of Malaysian Ivy admits" claim	Axiom Learning KL	Yes
TigerCampus admissions counselling services	TigerCampus counselling	Yes
TigerCampus RM70–100 and RM210–280/hour	TigerCampus pricing guide	Yes (Firecrawl scrape)
Ivy Summit KL page, schools served, list method	Ivy Summit KL	Yes
Ivy Summit package prices	Ivy Summit pricing	Yes

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
InGenius Prep Malaysia page; 57% Ivy+ claim	InGenius Prep Malaysia	No. Search summary only
True North: KL roadshow, Managing Partner for Thailand & Malaysia, 95% claim	Utusan (PR release), 10 Jul 2026	Yes
Abric Education, 2016	The Edge	No. Snippet only (404 on open)
Ezzy Consulting Service	Study International, 28 Nov 2025	Yes
Cambridge 263 Malaysian applications / 22 admits (2024); Oxford 679 (2022–24)	UniAdmissions Malaysia guide	Yes
Oxbridge Mentors £150 per personal-statement review	oxbridgementors.co.uk	No. Search snippet only
No Malaysian IECA member found	IECA site via search	No. Search summary only
Exchange rates used for RM conversions	`tools/shortlist_schema.py` FX table (ECB, 2026-09-05)	Yes (repo file)

Stream 3: colleges, international schools, scholarship bodies

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Taylor's UPS: one-stop centre, each student is assigned an advisor, partner list, non-partners "case by case"	college.taylors.edu.my UPS	Yes
Taylor's "over 200 top university partners", article is sponsored	says.com	Yes
Taylor's advisor KPI "placing all students to the universities of their choice", country custodians, CAS/ COE/ATAS/I-20	careers.taylors.edu.my Senior Education Advisor and related ads	No. Snippet only (opened pages were expired)
Taylor's Malaysia Sdn Bhd on the approved-agent list	liverpool.ac.uk approved agents	Yes
Sheffield's Malaysia agents: no colleges listed; it pays commission to agents	sheffield.ac.uk Malaysia reps	Yes
INTI on QUT's "other agents" list (ESOS definition)	qut.edu.au find a representative	No. Snippet only (403. Firecrawl got the ESOS wording but not the list)
Sunway IOUP services, mentors write references	Sunway A-Level guide 2025 PDF	Yes (text extracted)
Sunway JB Placement Unit	Sunway JB 2026 Pre-U brochure	Yes (text extracted)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
HELP SPC services, 44 partners, application-fee waiver	university.help.edu.my SPC	Yes
INTI UPO library, 150+ tables, 650+ MARA scholars since 2007	INTI AUP brochure PDF	Yes (text extracted)
MCKL University Placement job ad	mckl.edu.my	Yes
KTJ counsellor JD, 300-student sixth form	KTJ JD PDF	Yes (text extracted)
IGBIS counsellor JD "impartial, data-based"	IGBIS JD PDF	Yes (text extracted)
ISKL 7-person team, 550+ offers, destination split	iskl.edu.my Beyond ISKL	Yes
ISKL "3 counselors" (parent review)	talesmag.com	No, snippet only
Alice Smith uses Unifrog	alice-smith.edu.my	Yes
Cempaka × Uni Enrol Pathway Match	articles.unienrol.com	Yes
JobStreet counsellor listings and pay (Regent, Han Chiang, Garden, Taylor's, INTI, JM Education)	my.jobstreet.com college-counsellor-jobs	Yes, via Firecrawl scrape

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Taylor's School Group pays agents commission	tis.edu.my school agents	Yes
348 international schools, 111,185 students, 67% local	Asia News Network	Yes
AIMS 40+ members (2019)	aimsmalaysia.org	Yes
6% service tax on fees above RM60k	malaysia4u.com guide	No, snippet only
1:500 counsellor ratio "outdated", 1:250 target	NST 17 Aug 2026	Yes
Khazanah approved list, apply directly, "Full" coverage	yayasankhazanah.com.my Global	Yes
Khazanah RM20m for 72 scholars (2013), RM61.9m for 286	yayasankhazanah.com.my media (Bernama 2013)	Yes
Khazanah 115 awards in 2024, 1,610 since 2006	yayasanhasanah.org	Yes
BNM approved lists, coverage, 2:1 bond	bnm.gov.my scholarship	Yes
Petronas destinations and eligibility	petronas.com	Yes
Petronas picks the country, the student picks the university (2009)	news.westernu.ca	No, snippet only

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Yayasan Sime Darby's 10 approved universities, coverage	yayasansimedarby.com	Yes
JPA RM38,115–277,515 per overseas scholar a year, 744 cut, RM240m, 7,736 abroad	FMT 17 Mar 2016	Yes
JPA PPN: KYUEM, 20 QS universities, top 30	EduAdvisor JPA 2025	Yes
JPA 640 places in 2026, 30 PPN, convertible loan	Bernama BM	No, snippet only
MARA 30% Australian discount, RM200–300k saving per student, 2+2/3+1	NST Feb 2026	Yes
MARA moved ~200 from the US, approved list, Edinburgh 20%	Sinar Harian 16 Jun 2025	Yes
MARA 600 departures, Imperial 11, top-10/20, Al-Azhar RM350k	Bernama 2026	Yes
MARA 3,896 overseas (2022)	Bernama	No, snippet only

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
MARA 2020 guideline: offer from a JPA/ professional-body approved list	MARA PRO-P guideline PDF	Yes (text extracted)
IIE placed 25 MARA scholars at US institutions (2015)	iie.org	No. Snippet only (404 on open)
Johor RM5m scheme, >RM1m per UK student	Malay Mail 2024	No. Snippet only (403)
KYUEM 95%+ go overseas (2013)	Borneo Post	No, snippet only

Stream 4: private universities and branch campuses

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
SEGi FY2025 revenue RM207.5m, PBT RM10.3m; marketing RM9.33m (2024 RM8.01m); agent commission amortised over 2–3 years; contract cost asset RM20.1m (2024 RM13.1m); 40% international; scholarships RM173k + RM759k; SPARK system	SEGi Annual Report 2025, via investor page	Yes (PDF downloaded and text extracted; investor page via Firecrawl)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
SEGi Q1 2024 profit fell 22% on higher student acquisition cost	The Edge Malaysia, 16 May 2024	Yes
MEDIU commission schedule (RM300 / RM1,000 / RM2,000 / RM1,500), two-stage payment, agents can't charge students	MEDIU agent agreement PDF	Yes (PDF pages read)
USIM RM1,500 per student, paid RM750 + RM750	USIM agent page	Yes
UTHM RM2,000 agent / RM1,000 introducer; RM500 registration	UTHM agent scheme	Yes
Taylor's bursary "is a form of discount... advised by the appointed Counsellors"; TEG progression bursary up to RM8,000 / RM4,000	Taylor's UG scholarships brochure 2026	Yes (PDF extracted)
Sunway College JB Continuing Bursary: 10% for progression	Sunway College JB 2026 PDF	Yes (PDF extracted)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Sunway American degree programme: placement office, "selecting suitable universities", ASU "exclusive partner"	Sunway SAE, Why Study Here	Yes
JCF owns Sunway Education Group; not-for-profit	JCF foundation structure	Yes
JCF RM75m awarded 2025, RM967m+ cumulative	Sunway University news, 7 Nov 2025	Yes
Heriot-Watt Malaysia Education Consultant ad (conversion, CRM tagging, scholarships "to drive urgency", weekends and travel)	JobStreet 94859953	Yes (via Firecrawl, because WebFetch was blocked with a 403 error; saved `.tmp/b2b_research/04_7_jobs.json`)
INTI Education Counselor ad ("selling skills", "sales target", sales incentive, weekends); INTI 17,500 students, 1,001–5,000 staff	JobStreet 94792497	Yes (via Firecrawl)
INTI School Partnerships ad (lead funnel, "not just attendance")	JobStreet 94728832	Yes (via Firecrawl)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
UNITAR "Global Sales" counsellor ad, KPIs, competitor monitoring	JobStreet 94730094	Yes (via Firecrawl)
Live recruitment roles (Reading Malaysia, SEGi, IMU, MAHSA and others), counsellor roles filed under Sales	JobStreet student recruitment listings, international admissions listings	Yes (via Firecrawl; `.tmp/b2b_research/04_6.json`)
UCSI Executive (Agent Management): 20% growth targets, competitor intelligence	UCSI careers page	Yes (via Firecrawl; WebFetch was blocked with a 403 error)
UCSI open day "Free Career Matching Analysis"	UCSI Open Day 2019	Yes (via Firecrawl)
Swinburne Sarawak recruitment executive: agents, "education aggregator sites", school counsellors, budget per market	Swinburne PD PDF (effective Jan 2025)	Yes (PDF extracted)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Taylor's: 2.7% online lead-to-enrolment, 11% via chat, 60,000 contacts, peaks of 10,000+, Salesforce, response time 1h20m to 17m	SleekFlow customer story	Yes (vendor's own claims)
Taylor's international recruitment executive: targets, school visits, sales pipeline	Taylor's careers	No, search snippet only (posting had expired when opened)
UNM: AI agent NOVA on Salesforce; over 50% of applicants international; out-of-hours enquiries	UNM press release, 15 Dec 2025	Yes
Monash Malaysia authorised agents in 33 countries	Monash Malaysia agents page	Yes (via Firecrawl; WebFetch was blocked with a 403 error)
IDP adds Malaysia as a destination (phased pilot, April 2026)	PIE News, 23 Apr 2026	Yes (via Firecrawl)
EMGS 2025: 95,522 new applications, +17%, degree-level +25%	EMGS 2025 Annual Highlights	Yes (PDF downloaded and extracted)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
159,138 international students; public 56,565; total 1,264,541 (as at 31 Dec 2025)	MOHE statement PDF, 5 Jul 2026, Newswav/Malay Mail	Yes (both)
452 → 384 institutions; 558,692 private students (2023); 10–20% of revenue on marketing (no Malaysian data); price competition	Penang Institute, 27 May 2025	Yes
"Obscure private college... will pay generously"; MOHE scrutiny of Bangladeshi applications	Prothom Alo op-ed, Sep 2026	Yes
56% of international students at Malaysian institutions agent-recruited (2012)	Inside Higher Ed citing OBHE	No, search snippet only
EMGS agent workshop: 70+ agencies, 30+ institutions (2022)	EMGS media release	No, search snippet only
Nottingham pitched Malaysia at ~£30k total versus ~£46k for England	Times Higher Education, "Be quids in at our branches abroad"	No, search snippet only

Stream 5: existing B2B software

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Cialfo: features, 1,000+ university network, ISKL logo	cialfo.co/counselors-schools	Yes
Cialfo: 1,000+ HEI partners, 1,600+ schools, 310,000 students, university services	cialfo.co/universities	Yes
Cialfo Direct Apply: 1,200+ partners, 15,000+ universities in database, 75,000+ programmes	cialfo.co/what-is-direct-apply	Yes
Cialfo homepage: student list-building, Cialfo Guides, Direct Apply	cialfo.co	Yes (via Firecrawl, `.tmp/b2b_research/05_4.json`)
Cialfo sells subscriptions to schools; 170+ staff	TechCrunch, 26 Jan 2022	Yes
Cialfo "partnership fees from universities"; US$60m Series B	Search summaries of Dealroom, Business Standard	No, search snippet only
Cialfo Capterra: 0 reviews, "Basic SGD48 flat rate per month"	Capterra	Yes (via Firecrawl; WebFetch was blocked with a 403 error)
Cialfo pricing not public; pros and cons	Lumiere Education review	Yes (via Firecrawl)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Cialfo client-partner role covering SE Asia and Saige	startup.jobs	No, snippet only (403)
Manifest Global owns Cialfo and BridgeU; BridgeU history	PIE News, Apr 2025	Yes
Manifest launch; Cialfo K-12 only; Explore and Kaaiser	PIE News, Jan 2025	Yes
Manifest buys EduGo Abroad; portfolio list	PIE News, Aug 2026	Yes
BridgeU free-to-use, 1,200+ schools, 416,000+ students	bridge-u.com	Yes
BridgeU 26,000+ institutions; 12 destinations; partners with universities	bridge-u.com/faqs	Yes
BridgeU recommendations by target grades and preferences	bridge-u.com/platform-overview	Yes
BridgeU free to schools since 2019, revenue from universities	Dealroom / Simplify	No, search snippet only
BridgeU university package £1,000 a year	Capterra BridgeU Connect	Yes (via Firecrawl)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
EAB resells BridgeU to US colleges (Jan 2024)	EAB press release	Yes
Unifrog features, 20,000+ programmes	unifrog.org/international-schools	Yes
Unifrog sold as subscription to schools; university partners	Unifrog blog	Yes
Unifrog primary £600 a year; 4,000+ secondary schools	Unifrog blog	Yes
Unifrog about 250 Asian schools in 2018	Unifrog blog	No, search snippet only
Unifrog reviews 4.9/76 and complaints	EdTech Impact	Yes
MaiaLearning size and competitors	PitchBook	No, search snippet only
Scoir US$2.40/ US$4.80 per student, US$250 setup	scoir.com/high-schools/pricing	Yes
Scoir colleges pricing page exists	scoir.com/colleges/pricing	No, search listing only
Naviance/ Intersect paid messages, US$142,000 contract, "pay to play"	The Markup, 13 Jan 2022	Yes

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Naviance US$17.25m settlement	classaction.org, studentprivacymatters.org	The second page was opened via Firecrawl; the figure is from the search snippet
Naviance Newburgh contract US$37,211	CivicIQ	No, search snippet only
ApplyBoard: 150,000+ programmes, exclusive institutions, 95% success, Elevate	applyboard.com/recruitment-partners	Yes
ApplyBoard earns revenue share on landed students	Crunchbase News, May 2020	Yes
ApplyBoard is one of Edinburgh's agents in Malaysia	ed.ac.uk agents in Malaysia	Yes
ApplyBoard Trustpilot: 2 reviews	Trustpilot	Yes
Adventus 100%/ 80% commission, 4.95%/2.95% fees, 5 applications per student	adventus.io/pricing-recruiters	Yes
Adventus 1,300+ institution partners; Malaysia a destination	Adventus profile PDF	No, search snippet only
Aggregator concerns, Asia Careers Group, US$100 per 5 students, sub-agent survey	PIE News, 13 Apr 2021	Yes (via Firecrawl)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Edvoy 6,000+ partners; Leverage commission on applications and deposits	PIE News, leverageedu.com	No, search snippet only
Agentcis US$7 per user per month, US$400 setup, features	agentcis.com/pricing	Yes (via Firecrawl; WebFetch saw no prices and a US$500 setup fee)
Agentcis A$10–30 per user per month by tier	Enterprise DNA	No, search snippet only (a competitor's site)
Meritto serves Malaysia; no shortlisting	meritto.com blog	Yes
Zoho and HubSpot ranked for Malaysian education CRM	Krowdbase	No, search snippet only
Studyportals CPM/CPC/CPL or enrolment-based	studyportals.com	Yes
Uni Enrol Pathway Match at Cempaka	Uni Enrol article	Yes
1UNi defunct	Dealroom	No, search snippet only
Crimson app and calculators; strategist builds the list	YourTeen	No, search snippet only
Alice Smith uses Cialfo; Uni-Fit, Sage, "can only suggest"	Alice Smith blog, Nov 2023	Yes
IGBIS uses Cialfo (Oct 2022)	IGBIS newsletter 311	Yes

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
King Henry VIII College uses BridgeU	kinghenryviii.edu.my	Yes
Epsom uses Unifrog (2025)	epsomcollege.edu.my	Yes
Epsom used BridgeU (2019 images)	epsomcollege.edu.my	Yes
Epsom University Guidance Counsellor role	LinkedIn search snippet. It came from an individual's personal profile, not a job ad, so the link was removed under the brief's no-PII rule	No, search snippet only
UCSI International School uses Unifrog, which shows "tuition costs"	ucsiinternationalschool.edu.my	Yes (via Firecrawl; WebFetch got a 403)
Straits International School Rawang uses Unifrog	rawangsisgroup.edu.my	Yes
Kinabalu International School uses Unifrog (2020)	kis.edu.my newsletter	Yes
Sri KDU Klang uses Unifrog	srikdu.edu.my newsletter	No, search snippet only
Oasis International School uses MaiaLearning	ois.edu.my	Yes
UOW Malaysia agent portal (example of a university-run agent tool)	uow.edu.my/agent-hub	Yes
Taylor's College placement roles	Hiredly	Yes, but the ad had expired and the text was gone

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
348 international schools, 111,185 students	Malay Mail, Sept 2024	No, search snippet only

Stream 6: selling, events and rules

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
PDPA amendment phases: 1 Jan / 1 Apr / 1 Jun 2025; processor security, penalties, whitelist removal (Apr); DPO, breach notification, portability (Jun)	Rajah & Tann news alert	Yes
Amendment Act text: s5(1A) processor must comply with Security Principle; penalty raised to RM1m / 3 years; s9 covers processors; s12A processor DPO; s129 changes	Act A1727 PDF, pdp.gov.my	Yes (downloaded and read)
Definitions of "data processor" and "relevant person" (under 18 → parent); Security Principle wording	Act 709 PDF, pdp.gov.my	Yes (downloaded and read)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
DPO thresholds 20,000 / 10,000 (sensitive incl. financial) / systematic monitoring; controllers and processors; residency 180 days; BM + English; 21 days to register; outsourcing allowed	Commissioner's DPO Guideline PDF	Yes (downloaded and read)
Breach notice 72 hours; data subjects within 7 days; >1,000 = significant scale; s12B does not directly apply to processors; contractual duty; clock starts when processor notifies; RM250,000 / 2 years	Commissioner's DBN Guideline PDF	Yes (downloaded and read)
List of guidelines and circulars, incl. Circular 1/2026 on registration	pdp.gov.my Act page	Yes (the circular PDF is a scan; text not readable)
13 registration classes; Education = private HEIs (Act 555) and private schools (Act 550); no class for agents	pdp.gov.my relevant documents	Yes

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
DPO / DBN summary cross-check	DLA Piper Privacy Matters	Yes
UK National Code 2021: not a legal document; 1.4 represented vs not; 2.2 institution-pays vs student-pays; 4.1 "capacity to pay"; 4.3 best interests; commission amount not disclosed; spot-check audits	National Code PDF, winchester.ac.uk	Yes (downloaded and read)
A July 2025 edition of the National Code exists	ccoex.com PDF	No (403); search snippet only
British Council hub: free online training, certificates, public database of certified agents and counsellors	britishcouncil.my hub; britishcouncil.org hub	Yes (via Firecrawl, `.tmp/b2b_research/6_1.json`)
UK Education Insights Forum 2026, KL 21 Sep / JB 22 Sep	britishcouncil.my event	No (timed out); snippet only

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Australia: onshore-transfer commission ban (Jan 2026; accepted on or before 31 Mar 2026 exempt); commissions info collection and agent transparency	education.gov.au legislative changes; ban fact sheet	Yes (via Firecrawl, `.tmp/b2b_research/6_3.json`)
National Code Standard 4.1–4.5 wording; TEQSA does not regulate agents	TEQSA sector alert	Yes (via Firecrawl)
ESOS bill 2025: commission data collection, cross-ownership scrutiny	ICEF Monitor, Oct 2025	Yes
ICEF Agency Status €325/yr, €30/month, €49 application, reference and financial checks, Code of Conduct	ICEF IAS terms	Yes
ICEF/PIER agent course exam €295	ICEF Academy EATC	No, snippet only
ICEF Asia 2026, Ho Chi Minh City, 10–12 June	schoolsandagents.com	No, snippet only
JobStreet: 90 study-abroad jobs; Uni Enrol, EduAdvisor, INTI, IDP, PSB ad wording and pay	my.jobstreet.com/study-abroad-jobs	Yes (via Firecrawl, `.tmp/b2b_research/6_2.json`, 15 Oct 2026)

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
MARA quotation: Bumiputera only, MOF-registered, owner-only briefing, online bids	MARA notice 086/2025/0026	Yes (downloaded and read)
Sunway Group Procurement: e-procurement, category list	sunway.com.my	Yes
Star Education Fair 2025 KL: 70 institutions, 100 booths, KLCC	starmediagroup.my	Yes
Star Education Fair 2026: KL 11–12 Apr; Penang/ JB booth counts	Eventbrite; search summary	No, snippet only
AIMS Teachers Conference 2025	nexus.edu.my	Yes
LEAM expo and First Malaysia Education Counsellors' Conference, Feb 2025	nuscholarship.nu.ac.th PDF	No, snippet only
MAPCU 49 members (2015); NAPEI 60+	berjaya.com; bettshow sponsor page	No, snippets only
EMGS agent workshop 2022: 70+ agents, 35 HEIs	educationmalaysia.gov.my	No, snippet only
UTM inbound-agent requirements	admission.utm.my	No, snippet only

Claim	Source	Did I open the page?
Morrisby: £25 per extra profile; £750/yr international schools incl. 30 profiles; from £995 sixth form	morrisby.com/pricing	Yes
Study in Europe per-lead plans €249–1,499/ month	studyineurope.eu/for-institutions	Yes
Studyportals offers CPM/CPC/ CPL, no published rates	studyportals.com	No, snippet only
Edvisor agency portal US$150/ month per campus	edvisor.io	No (404); snippet only
Counsellor ratio 1:500, target 1:250	NST Aug 2026; Malay Mail Jul 2026	No, snippets only (also in stream 3)
Forum evidence attempt (Reddit, Lowyat)	forum.lowyat.net/topic/4862042; Reddit r/malaysia threads	Lowyat yes (about school fees, not agents); Reddit not reachable
Cross-referenced figures (commission RM1,000–2,000; 10% first-year; Scoir, Unifrog, Agentcis prices; AIMS 40+; MARA/IIE 2015)	Streams 1–5 fragments in `business/b2b_research/fragments/`	Not re-opened by me; see those fragments' tables